OFFICIAL OPERATIONAL GUIDELINES: CENTRAL SECTOR SCHEME OF SCHOLAR

Ministry / Department: Ministry of Education | Level: Central

Target State: None

1. SCHEME OBJECTIVE & SCOPE

Merit-cum-means financial assistance to college and university students with outstanding Class 12 performance

Category: education. Subcategory: General.
Launch Year: 2008. Current Operational Status: open.

2. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA & CONDITIONS

The following deterministic conditions must be satisfied for beneficiary selection:

- Gross family annual income not exceeding Rs 4.5 lakh (Field: annual_income, Op: lte, Value: 450000)
- Above 80th percentile in relevant stream in Class 12 board exam (Field: percentile_12th, Op: gte, Value: 80)
- Pursuing regular full-time degree course (Field: education_level, Op: in, Value: ['undergraduate', 'postgraduate', 'college', 'university'])

3. FINANCIAL BENEFIT & ENTITLEMENTS

Benefit Type: scholarship
Maximum Benefit Amount: Rs 20,000 (yearly)
Repayment Obligation: Non-refundable financial grant / subsidy

4. REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION & VERIFICATION CHECKLIST
Applicants must possess and submit the following mandatory documents:
[x] 12th Marksheet
[x] Income Certificate
[x] College Bonafide Certificate
[x] Bank Passbook
[x] Aadhaar

5. APPLICATION PROCEDURE & OFFICIAL ACCESS
Official Portal: https://scholarships.gov.in
Official PDF Guidelines: https://www.education.gov.in/sites/upload_files/mhrd/files/Guidelines_CSSS.pdf
Application Window: 2026-07-01 to 2026-11-30

Verification Guidelines & Exclusions:
Rs 12,000/yr for first 3 years of UG; Rs 20,000/yr at PG level. Verified on NSP portal.